GigBid

Research & Development Report - Interim Draft

Individual AI-4016 Assignment II | Development checkpoint: 8 November 2026

Status	Evidence at this checkpoint
Prototype	A local React/FastAPI application, bid and conversation LangGraph workflows, and three development MCP servers exist.
Verified	Fifteen automated tests, the React production build, and GitHub CI pass. An earlier Docker bid run survived an API restart; the newer conversation path awaits a container check.
Unavailable	The instructor's GigSim starter kit and official evaluation data were not attached to the Classroom assignment at the time of this report.
Submission	This is an interim draft. It must not be treated as the final measured R&D; submission.

Research question

Can an evidence-grounded, human-reviewed agent workflow prepare safer freelance proposals while preserving a traceable decision and preventing unapproved marketplace writes? The current prototype tests the engineering path. It cannot answer marketplace quality or performance questions until the official simulator, personas, and evaluation split are available.

1. System design

The web inbox sends a job identifier to FastAPI. A typed marketplace port loads the job through the synthetic Marketplace MCP server in the Docker stack. A LangGraph fan-out runs an analyst, risk assessor, and fit matcher in parallel. The fit matcher calls the Portfolio MCP server's **search_evidence** tool through a real MCP stdio session. A decision node selects bid, watch, or skip from configuration thresholds. The bid branch prepares a price and a cited proposal draft, checks claim support and prohibited phrases, and pauses at a human approval interrupt. A synthetic draft is created only after approval. A separate conversation graph classifies a synthetic client message, reads mock interview slots through Workspace MCP, drafts a reply, and pauses before recording a synthetic message.

Boundary	Current implementation	Remaining integration
Marketplace	Typed port with synthetic MCP-backed draft and message tools	Instructor GigSim adapter and durable write idempotency
Evidence	Portfolio MCP over synthetic records; six retrieval variants in an experiment harness	Consented portfolio, official labels, chosen measured retrieval design
State	Memory locally; optional Postgres checkpointer in Docker	Restart test, outbox, scheduling, multi-tenant isolation
Human control	Dry-run previews and bid/message approval interrupts	Full reviewer studio and conversation escalation

Safety invariants

The demo adapter performs no live marketplace action. Rejection creates no draft or message. An edited proposal is held for renewed claim and compliance review; an edited reply is checked against forbidden phrases. Approval paths use separate idempotency keys. The Workspace server stores only local mock holds and email drafts. The API can require reviewer HTTP Basic authentication when both environment variables are configured; public deployment must use HTTPS and stronger tenant controls.

Traceability

Each graph run stores state and event labels, including extracted requirements, risk check, portfolio fit, decision, price, draft, compliance, and human action. A containerized run paused at approval, survived an API restart through Postgres, and finished after approval. This demonstrates checkpoint recovery for one synthetic run, not exactly-once marketplace writes under arbitrary failure.

2. Verification and R&D; method

The present checks establish only that the local development slice behaves as designed. They are not measurements on the assignment's hidden or official data.

Check	Observed result	Interpretation
Automated Python tests	15 passed on 8 Nov 2026	Bid and conversation approvals, MCP mock behavior, retrieval control flow, API routing, and reviewer authentication work locally.
React production build	Passed on 8 Nov 2026	TypeScript and Vite compile the current UI, including message review.
MCP protocol call	search_evidence returned typed synthetic records	The portfolio server can be called over MCP, and the fit node uses that path.
Retrieval smoke	4 tiny synthetic queries; V0/V1/V2/V8 returned all gold items	Real BGE embeddings ran; this trivial fixture is not comparative evidence or an official result. Cross-encoder model fetch is pending.
Docker Compose	Earlier bid check passed; new check pending	An MCP-backed bid approval survived API restart and created one synthetic draft. Docker stopped after a host restart before the conversation path could be checked.

Planned evaluation after the official kit arrives

Preserve the instructor's provided fixtures and train/dev/test split. Register the exact corpus and parser versions. Compare a transparent keyword baseline against at least four retrieval variants, including sparse, dense, hybrid, and reranked retrieval where feasible. Measure retrieval recall at k, citation support, unsupported claim rate, proposal quality with calibrated human judging, latency, and cost. Report confidence intervals and results by persona and job type. Include an ablation for evidence retrieval and a baseline graph comparison. Use the prescribed GigSim outcomes and release no hidden labels into the model prompt.

Release gates

The final report should include the exact dataset count, exclusions, label rubric, annotator agreement, seeds, model and prompt versions, per-variant tables, failure examples, trace links, and reproducible commands. None of those values is estimated in this interim draft.

3. Limitations and next steps

The synthetic jobs and evidence are small and hand-written. The deterministic writer does not demonstrate LLM reasoning or response quality. The retrieval smoke fixture has only four straightforward queries; perfect retrieval there cannot justify a production variant. The project still lacks the official GigSim adapter, real model service, scheduled worker, full RAG study, browser end-to-end suite, and public application deployment. The synthetic Portfolio MCP development release and technical write-up are public. The only verified system outcome is prototype behavior on the included examples.

Priority	Required work	Acceptance evidence
1	Obtain and inspect the official GigSim kit and evaluation data	Adapter contract, unchanged fixtures, data card
2	Complete GigSim integration, durable external writes, and conversation verification	Inspector snapshots, restart and isolation tests
3	Run measured RAG and graph evaluations	Reproducible scripts, labeled results, human panel, ablations
4	Deploy, publish, record, and submit	Live URLs, final commit, three-minute video, final PDF, private reviewer comment

Integrity note

No result in this document is described as an instructor evaluation. The report should be revised after the complete system and official data are available. A final submission must provide working public links and one coherent Classroom submission before the deadline.

Source and reproducibility

Implementation source: github.com/FazalZamanKhan/gigbid, main branch, development checkpoint. Assignment requirements: AI-4016 Assignment II brief in the course Classroom item, checked 8 November 2026. Commands: **PYTEST_DISABLE_PLUGIN_AUTOLOAD=1 .venv/bin/python -m pytest -q**, **npm run build**, and **python -m evals.runners.retrieval_eval** with the synthetic fixture and provenance label.